

Daily Economic Briefing

Wednesday 16 September 2026 (Asia/Phnom_Penh edition) | Window: Tuesday 15 Sept 2026 full US session/AH | Research cutoff approx. 20:08 ET Tue 15 Sept (00:08 UTC Wed 16 Sept) | Edition 21

Assumptions, corrections and scheduler status this edition

- Scheduler healthy** — 14th consecutive clean fire, single fire at 00:07:46 UTC (approx. 8 min after the 00:00 UTC slot), no duplicate, no gap.^[1]
- Fed Chair Kevin Warsh and the FOMC meeting date re-verified fresh** via federalreserve.gov: two-day meeting Tue–Wed 15–16 Sept, decision and Chair Warsh's press conference Wednesday 2:00pm ET.^{[16][17]} Note: the 2:00pm ET time itself was not re-time-stamped from a live source this cycle (the FOMC calendar page shows only the date) — carried forward from repeated prior confirmations, flagged to Annex A.
- Correction — Monday's VIX close:** the prior edition logged Monday 14 Sept's VIX close as 17.42 (single-sourced via news coverage during that day's total CBOE feed outage). Two independent sources today — the CBOE delayed-quotes feed itself (now returning a Monday-dated snapshot) and Yahoo Finance's historical table — both show Monday's actual close was **17.10**. Flagging the revision rather than silently rewriting history.^{[42][43]}
- Correction — Iran-GCC talks:** the prior edition described the Oman-mediated "Salalah" track as having collapsed over the weekend. Fresh reporting clarifies the talks were **postponed**, not collapsed — Saudi Arabia requested the delay citing Yemen-related developments, no new date set.^[26]
- Copper — exchange-certified source obtained:** a direct fetch from lme.com succeeded for the first time in several editions, yielding LME's official 3-month settlement. Comex's own settlement page remains unobtainable (JS-rendered, no usable data). See Section 4.^[38]
- AP wire gap:** the standard AP "How major US stock indexes fared" wire could not be located/indexed for Tuesday 15 Sept as of research time — a first-time gap in this recurring check. Index closes below rest on TheStreet plus multi-ETF-proxy triangulation (SPY/DIA/QQQ/IWM) instead.^{[1][3]}
- CBOE vol-curve feed** reverted to its usual thin-series-stale pattern (5 of 6 series still Monday-dated) after Monday's one-off total failure across all six series.
- Delivery/trigger-prompt note:** the scheduled task's own stored prompt still contains retired GitHub/Telegram delivery language, unchanged since edition 6 (now 15 editions running unaffected: 7–21). This edition follows the spec's Delivery section — SendUserFile only.

60-second read

1. **FOMC eve, and the market is pricing a real hike, not a coin-flip.** Wednesday's 2:00pm ET decision odds cluster 78–92% across Kalshi, Polymarket, a Reuters economist poll and futures-based citations^{[20][21][22][23]} — roughly steady to slightly wider than Monday's 84–92% band. A weak Empire State print (7.6 vs. 14.75 cons.)^[19] did nothing to dent it; the 10-year yield spiked intraday to approx. 5.045%, a 2007 high.^[1]

2. **Equities fell a second straight session** — S&P 7,585.73 (-0.45%), Dow 52,093.11 (-0.63%), Nasdaq 25,981.57 (-0.78%), Russell 2,867.27 (-0.86%)^[1] — as rising yields and surging oil outweighed the FOMC-eve calm typical of blackout periods. Energy was the lone sector standout (+2.17%); Consumer Discretionary lagged (-1.75%) on Dave & Buster's collapse.^[2]

3. **Two idiosyncratic financing stories, not earnings misses, drove the day's biggest single-stock moves.** Enova International fell approx. -23% after withdrawing its bid for digital bank Grasshopper Bancorp over regulatory-approval uncertainty^{[4][5]}; Axon fell approx. -10% on a \$1.0bn convertible-note dilution announcement.^{[7][8]}

4. **Oil extended its rally** — Brent approx. \$107.1 (+1.3%), WTI approx. \$103.1 (+1.6%)^{[31][34]} — after the Oman-mediated Iran-GCC "Salalah" talks were postponed at Saudi Arabia's request^[26] and Saudi Arabia's East-West pipeline remained shut following the 11 Sept drone strikes. Hormuz risk, not the Fed, is still setting the marginal price of crude into the decision.

5. **Volatility stayed cheap for the size of the event risk.** VIX closed approx. 17.20 (single-sourced)^[43] and SPX weekly options price only a approx. 1.1% implied move for Wednesday's announcement^[44] — thin insurance if the Fed's decision, dot plot or Warsh's press conference surprises either direction.

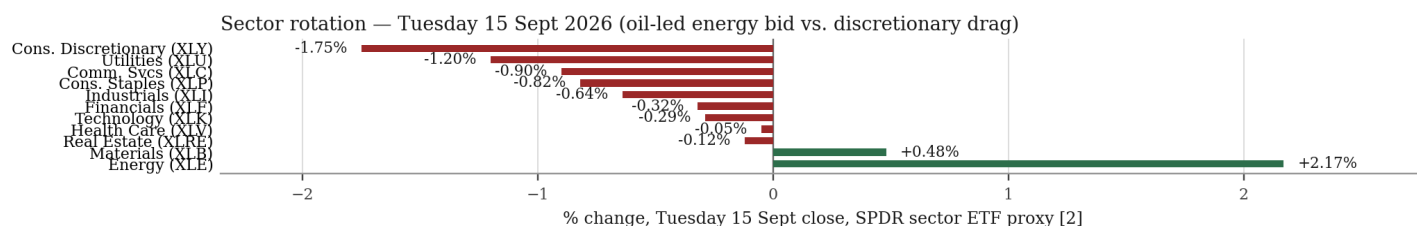
1. Market recap

S&P 500 7,585.73 -0.45%	Dow Jones 52,093.11 -0.63%	Nasdaq Comp. 25,981.57 -0.78%	Russell 2000 2,867.27 -0.86%	VIX 17.20 +0.58%	10Y UST (intraday hi) approx. 5.05% 2007-high
Brent approx. \$107.1 +1.3%			DXY approx. 99.6 +0.2%		

Tuesday marked a second consecutive losing session for US equities and the first full trading day of the Fed's two-day FOMC meeting. All four major indices fell, led by the Russell 2000^[1], corroborated by ETF-proxy moves in SPY (-0.46%), DIA (-0.62%) and IWM (-0.96%)^[3] — the standard AP wire that normally anchors this section could not be located for this session (see disclosure box), so today's closes rest on this multi-source triangulation rather than a single primary. The dominant cross-asset driver was a hawkish repricing of Wednesday's decision layered on top of a fresh Hormuz-driven oil spike: the 10-year Treasury yield spiked intraday to approx. 5.045%, its highest level since 2007^[1], while the dollar index rose for a fourth consecutive session.^[31] Energy was the session's only meaningfully positive sector; Consumer Discretionary, Utilities and Communication Services lagged on a mix of the oil-cost headwind and single-name drag from Dave & Buster's^[2] (full sector table and chart in Section 2).

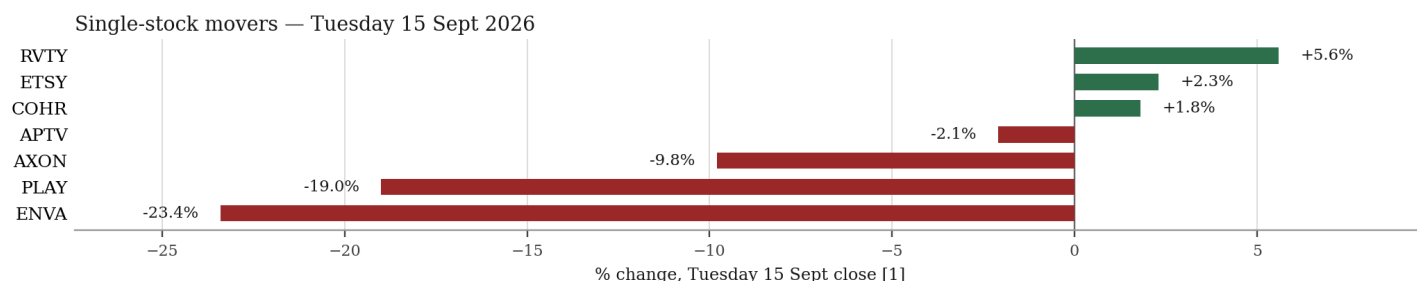
2. Equities and earnings

Sector rotation — Tuesday 15 Sept (SPDR sector-ETF proxy)



Energy led by a wide margin (XLE +2.17%) on the oil spike, with Materials the only other sector positive (XLB +0.48%). Consumer Discretionary was the clear laggard (XLY -1.75%), dragged down disproportionately by Dave & Buster's -19.0% collapse within the group; Utilities (-1.20%) and Communication Services (-0.90%) also underperformed as the rate backdrop turned less friendly to bond-proxy and high-multiple names.^[2] Technology (XLK -0.29%) and Financials (XLF -0.32%) held up better than the broader tape.

Single-stock movers



Ticker	Move	Driver
Enova International (ENVA)	approx. -23% to -24%	Withdrew pending regulatory applications to acquire digital bank Grasshopper Bancorp; CEO cited unclear nonbank-charter standards and political-influence risk in the approval process. Reaffirmed Q3 guidance (approx. 25% revenue growth, approx. 30% adj-EPS growth) despite the pullback. ^{[4][5]}
Dave & Buster's (PLAY)	-19.0% to \$6.86 (source conflict: one outlet's own text separately cited -12%; closing-price figure of \$6.86/-19.01% best corroborated) ^{[2][6]}	Monday-AH Q2 results reacted to in Tuesday's regular session: adj. EPS \$0.27 beat (\$0.18 est.) but GAAP swung to a \$12.5m net loss; revenue \$544.1m missed approx. \$556.8m est.; comp sales -2.9%. Read-across: Six Flags -2% to -3.4%, Lucky Strike Entertainment -1%. ^[2]
Axon Enterprise (AXON)	approx. -9.8% to -10.8%	Announced \$1.0bn offering of 0% convertible senior notes due 2031 (plus \$150m over-allotment) and expanded its revolver to \$500m from \$300m; capped-call transactions offset some dilution. Wall Street kept Buy ratings, but the financing news itself triggered the selloff. ^{[7][8]}
Aptiv (APTV)	-2.1% to a fresh 52-week low (approx. \$44.79)	JPMorgan downgrade, Overweight → Neutral, PT \$65 → \$56 — part of a sector-wide Tier-1 auto-supplier call the day before FOMC. ^[9]
Coherent (COHR)	+1.75%	Modest rebound after Monday's -12.7% AI-safety-driven plunge; no fresh Tuesday-specific catalyst identified. ^[15]
Etsy (ETSY)	approx. +2.3% to +2.9% intraday	Oppenheimer upgrade, Perform → Outperform, PT \$90 (new) — AI-search product benefits and improved app engagement cited. ^[12]
Revvity (RVTY)	approx. +5.6% (one source separately cited +9.1% — unresolved conflict, see Annex A)	New 52-week high; no single sharp catalyst identified, reads as sector/momentum drift rather than news-driven. ^[1]

Elsewhere: JPMorgan's same auto-supplier note also cut Lear (Overweight → Neutral, PT \$175 → \$150) and Magna International (Overweight → Neutral, PT \$77 → \$72), citing limited near-term growth catalysts.^{[10][11]} Wells Fargo upgraded Ulta Beauty (Underweight → Equal Weight, PT \$450 → \$525) on better-than-expected navigation of industry headwinds; Guggenheim upgraded New York Times (Neutral → Buy, PT \$82); RBC upgraded ResMed (Sector Perform → Outperform, PT \$262) on sleep-apnea penetration.^[13] Vera Bradley beat Q2 estimates before Tuesday's open (EPS \$0.11 vs. \$0.01 est., aided by \$7.7m in tariff refunds; revenue \$71.65m vs. \$70.89m est., returning to profitability) and reiterated FY guidance; shares were indicated approx. +16.8% premarket, though the confirmed regular-session close was not obtainable.^[14] Monday's Amodeli-essay-driven chip-selloff/cybersecurity-rally rotation largely paused rather than reversed: SMH flat (+0.11% after -4.75% Monday), Intel flat (-0.05% after -5.6%), while cybersecurity's CIBR decelerated to +0.95% (from +5.99% Monday) — momentum on both sides of Monday's trade clearly cooled as attention shifted to the Fed.^[15]

3. Macro, policy and rates

Fed Chair Kevin Warsh (confirmed Chairman, plus Jefferson as Vice Chair, Bowman as Vice Chair for Supervision, Barr, Cook, Waller as Governors, and Powell now a plain Governor) and the **15–16 Sept FOMC meeting date** were both re-verified fresh against federalreserve.gov today.^{[16][17]} No Fed official spoke publicly Tuesday, consistent with the blackout period that began 5 Sept.^[18]

The **Empire State Manufacturing Index** for September registered 7.6, well below the 14.75 consensus^[19] — a notable miss, though it did not visibly move rate-odds pricing. Odds for Wednesday's decision clustered **78–92%** for a 25bp hike across a Reuters poll of 101 economists (85%, published Monday, with 53% now seeing at least one more hike by end-March 2027 — a sharp reversal from the prior week's two-thirds-hold consensus)^[20], prediction markets (Kalshi/Polymarket ranging approx. 78–88%)^{[21][23]}, and secondary futures-based citations as high as approx. 85–92% (CME's own page remains unfetchable and is cited only secondhand).^[22] This is

roughly steady to marginally wider than Monday's 84–92% band. The prior edition's specific "10-2 vote, Waller/Bowman dissent" forecast could not be freshly re-confirmed from any source this cycle and should be treated as carried-forward and unconfirmed rather than restated as settled.

No new US-Canada tariff developments were found; Canada's CA\$27.6bn retaliatory tariffs (effective 8 Sept) remain in place, and the White House's possible reconsideration of its 15% refined-copper tariff remains confirmed-stalled with no incremental news. **Iran/Hormuz:** the Oman-mediated "Salalah" Iran-GCC ministerial track was postponed, not collapsed as the prior edition put it — Saudi Arabia requested the delay citing Yemen-related developments; Iran's foreign ministry called the postponement "a diversion from the root causes of this crisis."^[26] This follows Saturday's fatal strike near Hengam Island and a separate tanker incident near Limah on 12 Sept (both previously reported)^{[24][25]}; Hormuz vessel transits remain sharply reduced. Import/export prices and industrial production, both plausibly due mid-month, could not be confirmed as released Tuesday — flagged to Annex A rather than assumed.

4. Commodities and FX

Instrument	Tue 15 Sept	Chg	Note
Brent crude	approx. \$107.1	+1.3%	4-source cluster; driver below. ^{[31][32][34]}
WTI crude	approx. \$103.1	+1.6%	3-source cluster; one outlier (\$105.48) discarded. ^{[33][34]}
Gold (Comex)	approx. \$4,290–4,297	approx. flat (-0.1%)	3-source cluster; USAGOLD's lower \$4,263.19 print disclosed as a minority read. ^{[35][36]}
Silver	\$62.82	-0.68%	2 independent sources agree. ^{[36][37]}
Copper (LME 3-month, official)	\$14,001/tonne (approx. \$6.35/lb)	-1.68%	Exchange-certified. Extends the decline from 10 Sept's \$14,875/t ATH. ^[38]
DXY	approx. 99.5–99.65	+0.15% to +0.22%	4th consecutive up day. ^[31]

Oil extended its rally on the Salalah-talks postponement and the continued shutdown of Saudi Arabia's East-West pipeline (5m bpd capacity) following the 11 Sept drone strikes, with no restart timeline announced. Gold and silver were little changed to modestly lower as the hawkish rate repricing offset some of the safe-haven bid from Hormuz risk. **Copper's long-running Comex-vs-LME "2026 ATH" question effectively resolved into an ordinary cooling market this edition:** a direct fetch from lme.com finally returned an official, exchange-certified settlement (\$14,001/tonne), which fits a coherent declining trend from Thursday 10 Sept's \$14,875/tonne peak (Rio Times) through Friday's \$14,233 (Rio Times)^[39] to Tuesday's print — Comex's own settlement page remains unobtainable via direct fetch, but the LME series alone is now clean enough to anchor the metal without relying on aggregator citations. In FX, the dollar index rose for a fourth straight session on the hawkish repricing; EUR/USD eased to 1.1551 (-0.35%, though the exact session this print belongs to carries a minor date-attribution ambiguity between two sources), GBP/USD touched a five-week low (1.3486) ahead of Thursday's Bank of England decision, and USD/JPY (154.55) and USD/CAD (1.3887) moves are single-sourced and carried with lower confidence.^{[40][41]}

5. Derivatives, volatility and positioning

VIX closed Tuesday at approx. 17.20 (+0.58% vs. Monday's corrected 17.10 close), sourced from Yahoo Finance and single-sourced for the exact print — the CBOE delayed-quotes feed reverted to its usual thin-series-stale pattern after Monday's total outage, with VIX, VIX9D, VIX6M, VVIX and SKEW all still carrying Monday-dated `last\_trade\_time` stamps; VIX3M showed only a Tuesday intraday snapshot (13:47 ET), not a verified close. VIX9D/VIX6M/VVIX/SKEW Tuesday closes are unavailable this edition.^{[42][43]}

Options positioning is notably light for the event risk ahead: SPX weekly options price only a approx. 1.1% implied move for Wednesday's announcement, alongside elevated hedging demand elsewhere — 1-month 25/50-delta put skew sits at its 73rd percentile, and three of the four largest single VIX-call trades of the year occurred in the prior two weeks (100,000+ contracts each, strikes 28–34, Oct/Nov expiries) — tail-hedging activity rather than a bet on the FOMC day itself.^[44] Single-stock volatility (VIXEQ, approx. 34.5%) sits well below index vol relative to its July norms, while implied correlation and dispersion both rose Tuesday — consistent with the tape trading more on the macro/Fed axis and less on idiosyncratic single-name dispersion into the decision.^[45] Nasdaq-100 vol (VXN) stood at 22.05 (+4.9%) and the MOVE index (rates vol) at 83.90 (+2.1%), both elevated pre-FOMC.^[46] **CFTC CoT** data remains dated 8 Sept (released 11 Sept); the next report, covering Tuesday 15 Sept's positioning, is due Friday 18 Sept — no fresh data this edition, a five-to-seven-day standing lag.^[47] No notable funding-market (SOFR/repo) dislocation was found for Tuesday.

6. The day ahead

Date	Event	Consensus / context
Wed 16 Sept, 2:00pm ET	FOMC rate decision, SEP/dot plot, Chair Warsh press conference	78–92% hike odds cluster across venues; the dominant catalyst of the week.
Thu 17 Sept	Bank of England rate decision	Consensus: hold at 3.75%. ^{[27][28]}
Fri 18 Sept, 3:30pm JST	Bank of Japan rate decision	Consensus: +25bp to approx. 1.25%, widely described as "all but certain." ^[29]
Fri 18 Sept	September triple witching	Approx. \$6.2tn in US options notional expiring (approx. 23% of total US options exposure) — Citadel Securities flags fading dealer long-gamma support into the expiry. ^[30]

Sector setup we take into Wednesday

- Energy carries the week's only clean positive catalyst (oil/Hormuz) independent of the Fed outcome; a hawkish surprise that also strengthens the dollar would work against it on the margin.
- Rate-sensitive cyclicals (autos, discretionary) go into the decision already de-risked — JPMorgan's Tuesday downgrade of the APTV/LEA/MGA trio and Dave & Buster's-driven Discretionary weakness both look like FOMC-eve positioning, not signal.
- The chip-vs-cybersecurity rotation from Monday's AI-safety essay has stalled rather than reversed; a hawkish Fed surprise would test both sides of that trade simultaneously via the rates channel.
- Thin FOMC-day options pricing (approx. 1.1% implied SPX move) alongside a largely stale VIX-curve read leaves limited visibility into how well-hedged positioning actually is heading into 2:00pm ET Wednesday.

Annex A — Data points sought but not verified this edition

- AP's "How major US stock indexes fared" wire for Tue 15 Sept — not found indexed; index closes rest on TheStreet + ETF-proxy triangulation instead.
- Exact 2:00pm ET time for Wednesday's FOMC decision/press conference — not shown on the live federalreserve.gov calendar fetch itself; carried forward from repeated prior confirmations, not re-timestamped this cycle.
- UBS's specific "10-2 vote, Waller/Bowman dissent" forecast — not found in any freshly fetched source this cycle; treat as unconfirmed carry-forward.
- Tuesday 15 Sept US import/export price index and industrial production releases — no dated 2026 release could be confirmed.
- An "Empire State index surged" headline from one aggregator conflicts with FXStreet's dated 7.6-vs-14.75 miss; could not confirm it describes the same release — discarded.
- Dave & Buster's exact closing move — one outlet's own text cited both -12% (intraday) and -19.01% (closing); used the better-corroborated -19.01%/\$6.86.
- Revvity's exact Tuesday move — approx. +5.6% (two sources) vs. +9.11% (one source); reported the lower, better-corroborated figure with the conflict disclosed.
- Skyworks Solutions and Dell Technologies Tuesday moves — likely stale-date data errors in at least one source tied each to unrelated prior sessions; excluded from the mover list entirely.
- Vera Bradley's regular-session closing price/% — only a premarket indication (+16.8%) could be confirmed.
- Options-implied-move vs. actual-reaction comparison for Tuesday's earnings names — no source surfaced this data.
- AOL's analyst-call roundup contained at least one internal error (an Etsy price target that duplicated Ulta's figure); non-corroborated single-source items from that roundup (Lilly, Rapid7, and five new coverage initiations) are lower-confidence.
- VIX9D, VIX6M, VVIX and SKEW Tuesday closes — CBOE feed stale on all four; no working secondary source found.
- VIX3M Tuesday close — only a 13:47 ET intraday snapshot found, not a verified close.
- WTI's \$105.48/+4.03% print (Investing.com) conflicts with a 3-source cluster near \$103.1; discarded as an outlier.
- Gold's \$4,263.19 print (USAGOLD) conflicts with a 3-source cluster near \$4,290–4,297; used the cluster, disclosed the minority read.
- EUR/USD's 1.1551 print carries a genuine Mon-vs-Tue date-attribution ambiguity between two sources.
- USD/JPY (154.55) and USD/CAD (1.3887) — each single-sourced, no corroborating second source found.
- Henry Hub natural gas and Freeport-McMoRan/Southern Copper Tuesday closes — not found; most recent confirmed data predates this window.
- Comex/CME's own certified copper settlement — still unobtainable via direct fetch (JS-rendered pages); LME succeeded, Comex did not.
- Tuesday-specific SOFR/repo funding commentary — no source found either way; treated as a data gap, not a "nothing happened" confirmation.

Annex B — Sources

- [1] TheStreet, "Stock Market Today (Sept. 15, 2026)," thestreet.com
- [2] 24/7 Wall St, Dave & Buster's/Six Flags/Lucky Strike, 247wallst.com, 15 Sept
- [3] Stockanalysis.com, SPY/DIA/QQQ/IWM ETF history
- [4] RTTNews, Enova International withdrawal, rttnews.com
- [5] Investing.com, "Why is Enova International stock tumbling," 15 Sept
- [6] Stockanalysis.com, PLAY history table
- [7] Blockonomi, Axon Enterprise convertible note, 15 Sept
- [8] Tradingpedia, Axon shares slide on \$1.0bn offering, 15 Sept
- [9] Ad-hoc-news.de, Aptiv/JPMorgan downgrade, 15 Sept
- [10] Investrade Morning Preview, 15 Sept 2026
- [11] Daily Political, Magna International/JPMorgan, 15 Sept
- [12] Investing.com, Oppenheimer/Etsy upgrade, 15 Sept
- [13] AOL, "Tuesday's Top Wall Street Analyst Research Calls," 15 Sept
- [14] GlobeNewswire, Vera Bradley Q2 FY2027 results, 15 Sept
- [15] Stockanalysis.com, SMH/INTC/COHR/CIBR history
- [16] Federalreserve.gov, Board of Governors biographies
- [17] Federalreserve.gov, FOMC meeting calendar
- [18] Federalreserve.gov, 2026 speeches list
- [19] FXStreet, Empire State Manufacturing Index, 15 Sept
- [20] Yahoo Finance/Reuters poll of economists, 14 Sept
- [21] Universal Asset Owners, "The Probability Desk," 14 Sept
- [22] TradingView/Cryptobriefing, Polymarket Fed-hike odds
- [23] DeFiRate, Fed decision odds tracker
- [24] GlobalSecurity.org, "Iran War Day 199," 14 Sept
- [25] CNBC, vessel struck Strait of Hormuz, 13 Sept
- [26] Jefferson City News-Tribune, Iran-Gulf talks delayed, 15 Sept
- [27] Cambridge Currencies, next BoE decision preview
- [28] InvestingLive, BoE decision preview (Goldman)
- [29] ING Think, BoJ preview, 25bp hike
- [30] Citadel Securities, "September Setup" market note
- [31] Investing.com, Brent oil historical data
- [32] Sunday Guardian Live, market pulse recap, 15 Sept
- [33] HDFC Sky, market data recap, 15 Sept
- [34] NordFX, "Market Pulse," 15 Sept 2026
- [35] TradingEconomics, gold commodity page
- [36] USAGOLD, daily gold/silver price history
- [37] FXStreet, silver price data, 15 Sept
- [38] LME, official copper 3-month settlement, lme.com
- [39] Rio Times Online, LatAm copper markets recap
- [40] FXMacroData, FX market recap, 15 Sept
- [41] Vantage Markets, GBP/USD forecast, 15 Sept
- [42] CBOE, cdn.cboe.com delayed-quotes JSON feed
- [43] Yahoo Finance, ^VIX historical data
- [44] CBOE Insights, options commentary, week of 14 Sept
- [45] Saxo Bank, "Options Brief," 15 Sept 2026
- [46] Saxo Bank, "Market Quick Take," 15 Sept 2026
- [47] CFTC, Commitment of Traders release schedule

Method: produced by an automated recurring research/drafting process. Every figure above traces to a named source in Annex B; where sources disagreed, the more authoritative or better-corroborated figure was used and the conflict disclosed (Annex A). Nothing is estimated, inferred, or filled from model memory — unverifiable items are listed in Annex A rather than guessed. Window: Tuesday 15 Sept 2026 full session/after-hours, research cutoff approx. 20:08pm ET (00:08 UTC 16 Sept). Not investment advice.